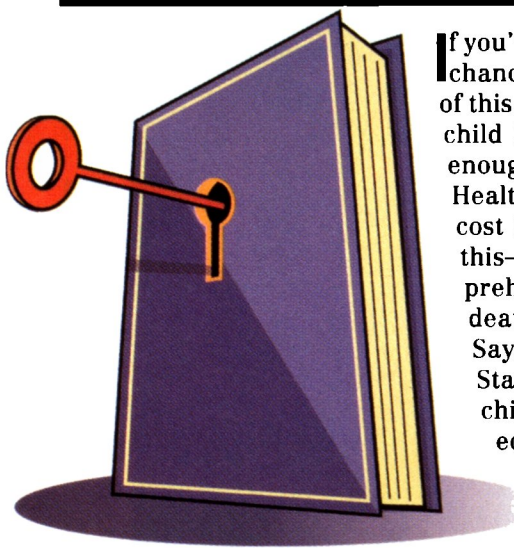


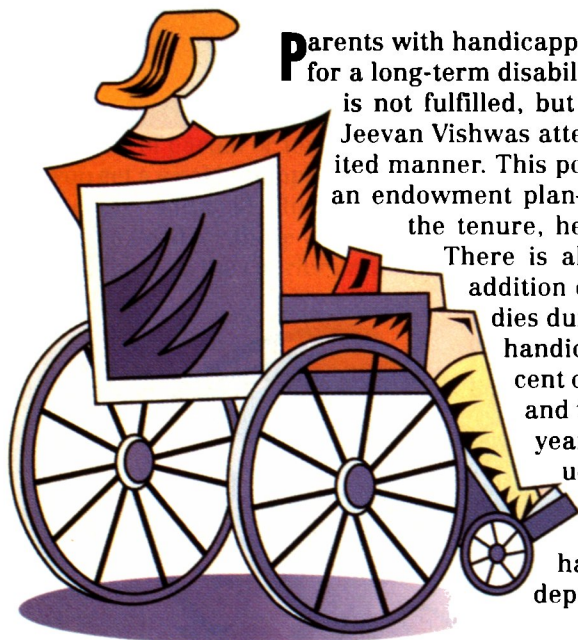
INSURE EDUCATION



If you've got children in school or college, chances are that you've already thought of this: what if you suddenly die when the child is still studying? Have you saved enough to cover school/college fees? Star Health & Allied Insurance offers a low-cost insurance product to take care of this—Student Care. It's far from comprehensive, but at Rs 60 for Rs 1 lakh death cover, it's definitely affordable. Says V Jagannathan, chairman and MD, Star Health & Allied Insurance: "Many children are unable to continue their education because of sudden demise of parents who paid for their education." It's a policy that's suitable for ageing parents,

especially when the child is in college. It's also a good idea for students exposed to health risks. The policy also covers health costs if the student meets with an accident.

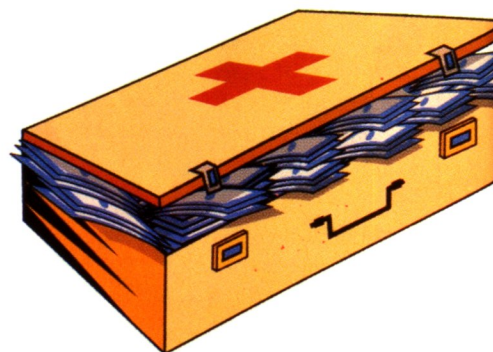
BRIDGING THE HANDICAP



Parents with handicapped children have felt the need for a long-term disability insurance policy. The need is not fulfilled, but Life Insurance Corporation's Jeevan Vishwas attempts to do so, albeit in a limited manner. This policy is essentially a variant of an endowment plan—if the policyholder survives the tenure, he gets the maturity proceeds.

There is also a guaranteed 6 per cent addition every year. If the policyholder dies during the term of the policy, his handicapped dependent gets 20 per cent of the proceeds as a lump sum, and the rest as an annuity for 5-15 years. Yes, the scope of the product is limited, but this is a policy that's possibly best suited to risk-averse individuals who have handicapped financial dependents.

CASH IN HOSPITAL



Health insurance takes care of medical expenses that result in hospitalisation. But what about expenses that are not covered by health plans being offered at present by insurance companies? The salary you lose, for instance? And your attendant might also be losing pay. Some general insurers now offer a hospitalisation cover that pays a fixed sum for the time (number of days) you spend in hospital. The policy costs Rs 250-4,500, for which you get Rs 500-2,500 for each day in hospital. The plan is valid for up to 30 days of hospitalisation a year, which can be split into stretches of, say, three or 10 days at a time. While this may not make hospitalisation pleasant, at least you won't lose too much in monetary terms.

If you have special needs, trawl the insurance market. You may find more undiscovered gems that seem tailor-made to your requirements. Very often, the sheer number of insurance products could put you off and leave you asking why you should bother with it at all. The answer lies in two words: what if. What if you die tomorrow, leaving your financial dependents with nothing to fall back on? With some homework, you can find an insurance cover that will let them maintain their current lifestyle even without your income.

Excerpted from **Money Today** story
"Covers you didn't know"

For more on insurance, read
Money Today issue
dated November 15

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